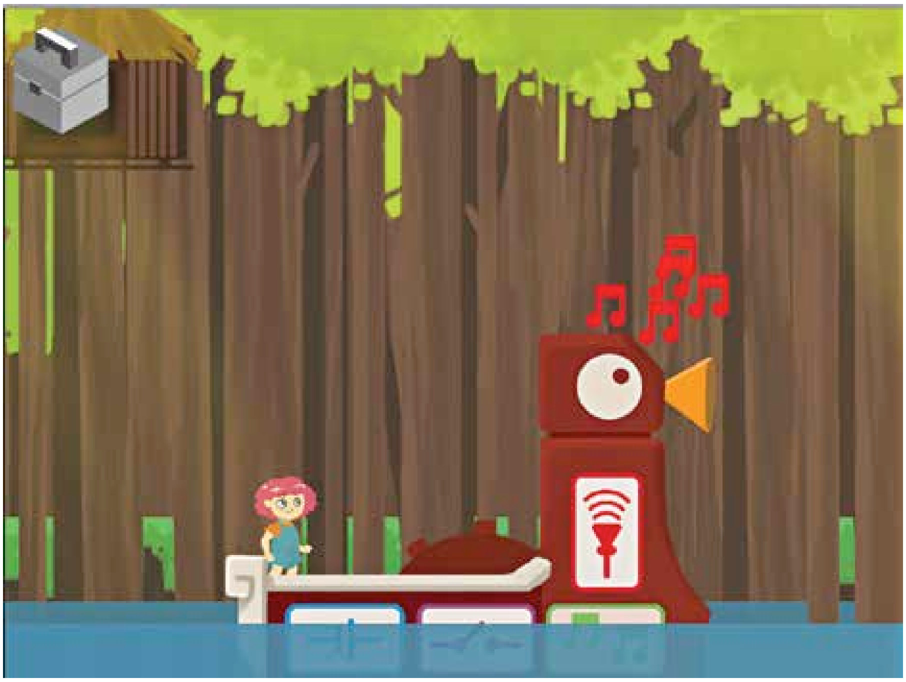
checking out if you want to get started with the mystical world of electronics but aren't too well versed with coding.

6 **Crumble** – Crumble is another programmable controller that comes with four connections that can be used either as Inputs or Outputs, and it can be easily connected with the help of crocodile clips. The starter kit comes with a Crumble board, croc leads, USB cable and two LEDs which can be programmed to any colour you want. The Crumble software is easy to use, especially if you have used Scratch before. All you have to do is arrange blocks together on the screen, connect your Crumble controller and Voila! Your program is transferred instantaneously to the controller. The LEDs that come with the Crumble starter kit are called sparkles and can be daisy chained together allowing you to come up with a number of interesting and pretty looking DIY projects. The more expensive crumble kits (super and ultimate) come with DC motors that can be used to create a number of more advanced projects.

7 **MakerBloks –** Aimed specifically for children, the MakerBloks is intended to teach kids, specifically aged six and above, to build and create electric circuits starting at a young age. The maker tech aims to build upon the idea that kids are already well used to playing with blocks. The kit comes with four different games meant to introduce kids the world of basic electronics. The bundle consists of coloured blocks that connect to each other magnetically. Each block represents an electronic component and features its symbol.

A guide explains each of the electronic symbols to kids and comes with instructions on how to use them, along with troubleshooting advice. The app bundled with it uses digital image processing and the front camera to figure out if the child has assembled the blocks correctly. MakerBloks is the ideal way to get your kid hooked on to the world of electronics and let him explore his creativity at an early age.

8 **Pirates Electronics** – The Pirates electronic's site says that their mission is "to teach the world electronics and empower hobbyists". The kit is a complete starter pack which can be used to build anything and almost everything ranging from a simple alarm to an autopilot system for drones. Starting off as another Kickstarter project, Pirates electronic has received pledges worth more than $35,000, thereby doubling the initial target. What sets it apart from the others on the list is that it comes with more than 300 pages of explanation detailing how each and every component of its kit works. Accessible online, this comprehensive manual of sorts covers the basics of electronics. Not only this but also each lesson has its own forum where you discuss your problem with the fellow "pirates" and experts in case you get stuck somewhere. The Kit comes with more than 500 components which include LEDs, a breadboard, light sensor, sound sensor and also a 7-segment LED, giving you a complete hands-on experience of working on and making circuits. The kit is expected to be delivered by September this year.


The MakerBloks app provides an intuitive platform for children to learn.

Behold the future

This list of emerging maker devices merely scratches the surface. There are many more similar DIY kits that can be used by anyone including beginners, experts and everyone in between the wide spectrum of electronics enthusiasts. 3D printing was just a Sci-Fi fantasy a decade ago. Now people are buying 3D printers for their home offices.

Gone is the time when kids used to play with Lego blocks building houses and cars. Today kids as young as 6-7 years of age are building smoke detectors and burglar alarms using DIY kits. People without any background in programming are learning and coding their own Arduino boards, making automated cars and talking robots.

You don't need expensive tools and equipment anymore, nor do you need an electrical engineering degree. All you need is a cheap microcontroller, a zeal to learn, some free time and then your imagination is the limit. 'Do It Yourself' is the word of the day and maker tech culture is here to grow and stay. So what are you waiting for? Get up and make a burglar alarm or the talking robot butler you always wanted.